



CROP CARE

Trailing types will need support, so construct bamboo cane structures or use netting. Give them plenty of water during growth, especially while fruits are developing, and feed them every two weeks with a balanced liquid fertilizer. You will need to hand-pollinate outdoor types yourself (see p.532).

HARVESTING AND STORING

Harvest while young, since leaving cucumbers too long can spoil the flavor of those left on the plant. Cucumbers do not store, but small ones can be pickled.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Discourage the spread of common diseases such as powdery mildew and cucumber mosaic virus by keeping plants well-watered and well-ventilated. Red spider mite or whitefly may be troublesome under glass. Guard young plants against slugs.



Red spider mite may mottle leaves.